Contract Review and Approval Playbook

Introduction

This document establishes standardized guidelines for managing commercial contract changes across HelioFreight Logistics. It aligns Legal, Sales, Operations, and Finance on roles, controls, and service-level expectations to support timely customer onboarding and renewals. The procedures apply to customer, carrier, and vendor agreements that impact warehousing and freight services. Consistent execution reduces cycle time, minimizes risk, and improves stakeholder transparency.

Contract Intake and Triage Standards

Contract intake is considered complete only after the full contract packet has cleared HelioFreight's formal e-approval sequence; if any approver rejects, Legal Operations must capture the rationale, revise the redlines, and re-route the packet through the required approvers before proceeding. Once approvals are finalized, the triage owner issues the customer-ready version for signature using the authorized sending channel (e-signature platform or approved email workflow) to avoid version drift and shorten cycle time. Following execution, the fully signed agreement is uploaded to the CLM repository as the system of record, with mandatory metadata (customer name, facility/region, service scope, effective/expiration dates) and clear version labeling to distinguish "approved," "sent," and "executed" copies. In parallel, the contract administrator creates an Obligation Tracker record in CLM (or the linked compliance tool) to document post-signature commitments that must be monitored, including SLA credit triggers, periodic reporting deliverables, audit-response windows, and insurance certificate renewal requirements. These standards ensure the redline approval process concludes with controlled signature release, accurate archiving, and enforceable obligation visibility for downstream operational teams.

Conclusion

Adhering to these guidelines ensures contract changes are reviewed consistently and approved with appropriate authority. Clear intake criteria, structured routing, and disciplined documentation reduce bottlenecks and prevent unauthorized commitments. When executed as designed, the process supports faster deal velocity while protecting HelioFreight's operational and financial interests. Leaders should monitor compliance and continuously refine controls based on audit findings and business needs.